



PS Vue on Roku

Sony's PlayStation Vue TV service is not available on Roku on TVs set-top boxes
<http://dgit.in/vueonroku>



Mrs. Obama joins Snapchat

Michelle Obama has joined Snapchat and is giving her followers snaps of the white house and her activities <http://dgit.in/MsObama>

Industry Connect

Akamai on gaming security



Gaming companies are increasingly storing more information on the cloud and delivering content on a requirement basis to the end user. With an influx of new users, comes the need for more security

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Q We know that Akamai is primarily a CDN. We recently also found out that Akamai has a play in gaming enablement. What can you tell us about that?

Akamai: So, in gaming we do a lot of things. Me, specifically, I'm the Chief Technology Officer of Security for all of Asia. We have customers that get attacked all the time. So we built a response team to go help respond to such instances. Apart from that say you want a mobile game, we're the ones that deliver it to you. There are lots of games that have DLC (Downloadable Content), and even large updates to the core game. Developers use us to deliver that, because, there's no traffic to the sites that have their downloadable content, and then they release it, and everybody wants it at once. We do quite a bit for the console manufacturers; things like the registration process for the device, the management of the user's online account, all of that takes place through our servers, depending on which particular platform it is. Then, pretty much a slice across all that.

Q What are the key challenges with the current ecosystem?

Akamai: For India it's definitely on the mobile side. On the mobile side, there are lots of people writing games, and the barrier to writing games is very small. But you'll have publishers that will write a large number of games, and they don't know which ones will be successful. So, it's really hard to figure out how much to provision. If one game is very popular,



Michael Smith, APJ Security CTO
Akamai Technologies

for whatever reason, and you actually need to have the resources to support that particular game. After the holidays for example we see a lot of users have new devices, and suddenly they're connecting them all, and downloading content. So, we have kind of this flash crowd, especially around the end of the year, and some of the other holidays. Ramadan and Eid for example are becoming holidays in their own right. You've got some attackers, out there. There was one holiday, like five years ago, where Anonymous decided that they were going to attack one particular game. But, it was just a casual, semi social game. They were actually going to crash it during the holidays, just with a simple DDOS attack, in order to force kids to spend time with their families. I actually might agree with some of the spirit of what they were trying to do there. But, officially, I can't. But really what it comes down to is: the resources required and the security knowledge. Gaming publishers, for the most part, depending on which publisher, might or might not have dedicated security resources. So, a simple thing is just account take over. If you look at account takeover, we see it in other places than gaming.

Users reuse credentials across multiple sites. Attackers know this. So, they'll do

a phishing attack, take over one of their e-commerce passwords, and then they'll use a tool called "Account Checker". If you go to YouTube, and search for "Account Checker game", you can videos in which people are demoing their tools, and recording it. They'll take a list, and it's usually username or email, and then to get the password, they'll look it up in the tool, which will go through a series of proxies, and see which one those it can actually log in to. Then the tool reports back to the attacker, and then they'll publish these on different sites, or they'll log into the account as the user, and find some way to cash out the user's account. So these are checking out, gift all of the user's goods to someone else, they'll see if the user has a card stored, buy material, find a way to have it shipped to them, then sell it on eBay. Basically, whatever way they can cash out of the account, they'll go do that. But, we've seen that it's almost a pandemic, at this point. It's surprising to see how heavily it's happening within gaming.

Q We've heard these hackers are a tough bunch and they have an arsenal of constantly evolving techniques – those that are run remotely and those that are client sided. These client sided techniques take effect before even the data reaches Akamai's servers. So how does Akamai combat these techniques?

Akamai: If you understand the way that our servers work, users follow a DNS to get to our servers, and then they make request, so we function like a proxy. So, in line there, we have a web application firewall, we've had it for about 6+ years, almost 7 years. It basically adds a security policy, on top of the delivery configuration. So you can look at a source IP address, and then when they send too many login requests, like say five requests in 5 seconds, there's not a human attached to that. There's some kind of automated program. So, you can lock them out for 10 minutes. Or you can require that the request looks a certain way. **Q**

(For full interview head over to dgit.in/akamaidgtjly16)